

The "Chama" Culture: Digitizing African Communal Savings to Bridge the Gender Gap in Financial Inclusion.

Abstract (English).

The "Chama" (informal savings group) is a cornerstone of African socio-economic culture, embodying the spirit of communal growth. Historically, Chamas have served as a vital financial lifeline for African women, allowing them to pool resources, access credit, and build wealth in societies where formal banking often excluded them. This presentation explores the cultural significance of Chamas and their critical role in promoting gender equity and financial independence. Furthermore, it analyzes the evolution of this cultural practice through the lens of Business and Information Technology (BBIT). By transitioning from manual record-keeping to digital platforms and mobile applications, Chamas are becoming sophisticated investment vehicles. The digitization of this African tradition not only preserves the culture but also enhances transparency, security, and scalability, proving that traditional values and modern technology can coexist to solve gender-based economic disparities.

Muhtasari (Kiswahili).

Utamaduni wa "Chama" ni nguzo muhimu ya kijamii na kiuchumi barani Afrika, unaoashiria umoja na maendeleo ya pamoja. Kihistoria, Chama zimekuwa mkombozi wa kifedha kwa wanawake wa Kiafrika, zikiwawezesha kuchanga rasilimali, kupata mikopo, na kujenga utajiri katika jamii ambazo mara nyingi ziliwatenga na huduma rasmi za benki. Wasilisho hili linaangazia umuhimu wa Chama na nafasi yake katika kuleta usawa wa kijinsia na uhuru wa kifedha. Aidha, linachunguza mabadiliko ya utamaduni huu kupitia Biashara na Teknolojia ya Habari (BBIT). Kwa kuhamia kutoka uwekaji kumbukumbu wa kawaida hadi mifumo ya kidijitali na programu za simu, Chama zinageuka kuwa vyombo vya kisasa vya uwekezaji. Udijitali wa utamaduni huu unalinda maadili ya jadi huku ukiongeza uwazi na usalama.

Muhtasari (Dholuo).

Timbe mag "Chama" (kata Ayie/Nyoluoro) gin timbe madongo ahinya e piny Afrika ma ji konyorego e weche pesa. Kuom higni mang'eny, Chama osekonyo mon mag Afrika ahinya, koweyonegi thuolo mar choko pesa kanyachiel mondo giloso ohala kata chulo gope, to molooyo ne mon ma ne ok nyal yudo mikopo e benk. Otambua-ni lero kaka Chama konyo mon chung' e tiendgi (Gender Awareness). Bende, walero kaka teknolojia (IT) koro loko timbe mag Chama. Ka watiyo gi simu kod program manyien, ok ochuno ni mon ti gi buge kata sanduku mag pesa. Lony-ni konyo mondo pesa obed e kar kago, kendo miyo Chama bedo gi teko mar loso ohala madongo.